Urban Acupuncture Projects as a Slum Upgrading Process
How to tackle poverty effectively in a multidimensional way: The case of *Ciudad Bolívar* in Bogotá

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A c k n o w l e d g m e n t s

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ANSPE – *Agencia Nacional para la Superación de la Pobreza Extrema*

– National Agency to Overcome Extreme Povery

CODENSA – *Empresa de Energía de Bogotá* - Energy Company of Bogotá

CODI - Community Organizations Development Institute

CMPI – Colombian Multidimensional Poverty Index

DANE – *Departamento Administrativo Nacional de Estadística* – National Department of Statistics

DNP – *Departamento Nacional de Planación* – National Planning Department

EAAB – *Empresa de Acueducto y Alcantarillado de Bogotá* - Water and Swage Entity of Bogotá

IDMC – Internal Displacement Monitory Centre

IDU – *Instituto de Desarrollo Urbano* - Institute of Urban Development

MDGs – Millennium Development Goals

MAVDT – *Ministerio de Ambiente, Vivienda y Desarrollo Territorial* - Ministry of Environment, Housing and Development

POT – *Plan de Ordenamiento Territorial* - Structure Plan

PMR – *Polígonos de Modalidad Reestructurante* – Restructuring nodules

PUI – Projecto Urbano Integral – Urban Integral Project

RDB – *Red de Bibliotecas* – Libraries' Network

SDP – *Secretaría Distrital de Planeación* - District Planning Secretary

UBN - Unsatisfied Basic Needs

UCDO - Urban Community Development Office

UN – United Nations

UNDP – United Nations Development Programme

UPZ – *Unidad de Planeamiento Zonal* - Zonal Planning Areas

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“ It is a right to change ourselves by changing the city. It is, moreover, a common rather than an individual right since transformation inevitably depends upon the exercise of a collective power to reshape the process of urbanization (Harvey, p. 23, 2008)

“Urban dwellers carry the urban with them, even if they do not bring planning with them!” (Lefebvre, p.158, 1996)

“[Slum] Upgrading is a great opportunity to make changes – involving all the communities in the city, changes in people within the relationships, changes in the way of thinking, changes in people’s own attitudes towards themselves and their position in their society and cities. Upgrading, if it’s done properly, can really liberate people”
(Boonyabancha, p. 45, 2005)

1 Introduction

Nowadays, poverty is one of the main social issues to tackle in urban centres primarily because for decades cities were incapable of incorporating the large influx of migrating people from rural areas. The newcomers had few opportunities for employment or to join the housing market. As a result, informal settlements emerged to accommodate poor urban dwellers with little economic capacity or access to urban facilities (Greene and Rojas, 2010). The United Nations (UN) numbers show the vast majority of the population growth from Latin America since the 1970s has been taking place in urban areas (2002). According to the World Bank data, 60% of the poor and half of the extreme poor of Latin American countries – 113 million and 46 million respectively – live in urban centres, and 20 to 25% of these urban poor live in overcrowded slums (2000). This tendency will continue for the following years. Can tactical urban interventions at specific points in the city provide positive solutions and foster the change marginal communities need? This paper aims to explore the possibilities urban acupuncture could provide in strategic locations in Bogotá, Colombia.

It is recognised that slums are the only option urban poor have to access shelter and reside in cities. Furthermore, slums have a key role to play in the housing provision for many poor people, who do not have the economic capacity to afford a formal housing unit or to buy land. As the more accessible solution for many people, slums are not close to diminishing nor disappearing. “Under these circumstances, it simply will not be possible to make slums disappear by bulldozing them. Cities that destroy a slum community find that their other slum communities grow large” (Painter et al., 2006). Slum conditions of habitability are, in general terms, poor and hard to upgrade. It takes a great deal of energy and political will from the local authorities and economic investment. The inhabitants have to deal daily with rough and poor housing conditions, lack of infrastructure, and unfavourable physical environments (E.g. water, public space, sanitation, energy, transportation and accessibility). With this overwhelmingly difficult situation, an innovative and different answer should be offered, since the simplistic eradication of slums (tabula rasa [1]) is not feasible, and the problem is growing everyday.

The current situation the majority of the developing cities are suffering is the result of weak public authorities, incapable of reacting and planning in an effective way to deal with urban chaotic growth. The institutions are unable to formulate effective and strong programmes because most cities do not have the specific normative framework for a concrete process for slum-improvement (Patel et al., 2011). Another hindrance is the institutions’ current sectoral approach to housing policy formulation. They are restricted to solve house provision in urban centres without recognizing and dealing with the fact that ‘housing’ includes many activities and processes. John Turner explains that to use people as agents of change, housing is the perfect scenario to generate that change (1972). The problem is that in most cases, governments remain satisfied providing housing units, regardless of the location, connectivity, and opportunities people have in the housing projects. They see unit provision as the sole target to address the housing deficit. It is critical to understand housing, and even more housing policies, as the medium to enhance the dwellers’ quality of life and generate inputs and services for marginal communities.

Another important point to take into consideration is that housing policies are not necessarily restricted to housing provision. In many cases the most successful programs are urban projects with a broader scope and more impact on the community than some new units built in the outskirts of the city. Fortunately, there is a growing concern from multilateral agencies and governments to promote strategies, policies and programmes for social inclusion, poverty alleviation and spatial integration. There is a common agreement among development practitioners that the focus should be on the complexity and scale of the problem concerning the quality if life of thousands of slum dwellers (Calderón, 2008).

In order to contribute to solving this situation, the UN created the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). Their focus covers extreme poverty, universal education, gender equality, child mortality, maternal health and environmental sustainability. Also, target no 11 aims to have a “significant improvement in lives of at least 100 million slum dwellers, by 2020” (UNEP and UN-HABITAT, 2005) . Unfortunately, the target is not close being met, and scholars and policy makers have a very strong debate around what

[1] Blank slate

the real impacts of the MDGs are in practice.
One of the leading Latin American examples of innovative urban interventions and policies is Bogotá. In 2006, the Colombian capital was acknowledged as the "the case of best-practices in egalitarian urban transformation" due to its interventions in upgrading programmes with participatory approaches (e.g. "Mejoramiento Integral de Barrios", "Obras con saldo Pedagógico" and "Legalización de Barrios") (Calderón, 2008). Until the early 2000s, Bogotá had strong governmental institutions delivering effective transportation solutions and slum-upgrading policies including: the "Red de Bibliotecas" (Library Network), "Plan Maestro de Ciclorutas" (Cycle Paths Master Plan) or "TransMilenio" (BRT System) (ibid). These projects all together with the slum-upgrading policies are framed in the Plan de Ordenamiento Territorial POT (Bogotá Structure Plan). They determined 27 of the 117 "Unidad de Planeamiento Zonal (UPZ) de Mejoramiento Integral", city zones were to be included in the normative framework of local institutions for city slum upgrading (DNP and MAVDT, 2009; POT, 2004; 2006, Escallón, 2006). This legal framework is the platform for the social, institutional and economic revival of the most marginal neighbourhoods in the city (Calderón, 2008). Bogotá has the internal institutional capabilities to provide wellbeing to its inhabitants. Nonetheless the city and its institutions entered into a state of lethargy in the past decade due to its mayors.
It is interesting to understand how a city has the platform and regulatory structure since the 1990s to tackle poverty in a more effective way, but has a problem delivering these programmes and policies to the people. This paper examines in more depth the polígonos de modalidad reestructurante (PMR) "restructuring nodules" in Ciudad Bolívar in Bogotá and the future "Metrocable" intervention, which will have a station in the UPZ67 "El Lucero" on one of the 7 PMR. Within this case study, the author will evaluate how urban poor can embrace the concept of citizenship through empowerment from the policies and urban projects each city enacts. Also, to understand how these project and policies positively affects the security and security within the neighbourhoods spreading out to the rest of the city.

The purpose of this document is to analyse how Bogota could improve its slum-upgrading policies, having in mind that the city's normative framework encourages these types of practices to happen. In order to analyse the situation in a more realistic manner, this document brings Medellín's successful urban interventions around the MetroCable, acting as urban acupuncture nodules of change. In addition the Thai's Community Organizations Development Institute (CODI) will be introduced as an example of how institutions should incorporate a holistic view of every problematic and intervention. Furthermore, this paper will analyse how bottom-up and people centred interventions could generate more positive impact in a marginal population. A focus is on how the state is one of the principle actors working for that empowerment to happen.

[2] Winner of the Golden Lion Award for the category of Cities in the "Biennale di Venezia, 10th International Architecture
[3] The TransMilenio BRT System was first introduced in the year 2000 as the first massive transportation system in the City.

2 Literature review

Empowering citizens, a transformative way to get out of poverty

As a general statement, slums are the result of a combination of bad policies, failed governance, inappropriate regulation, corruption and lack of political will. Roy for instance argues "informality must be understood not as the object of state regulation but rather as produced by the state itself. Here the concept of the state of exception is useful" (Roy, 2005, p. 149). Additionally the responsibilities of the state today are reduced very much in comparison with previous times. In this time period, the state is no longer responsible for the production of goods and services (Gilbert, 2003). This reality displays a lack of commitment from the State. Evidently, there is a resulting overwhelming growth of the informal sector and its consequences, low quality of life, insecurity of tenure and income generation, and the spread of slums across the city.

This chapter will discuss firstly how slum-upgrading processes should bridge the inequality gap; secondly why poverty should be tackled with a multidimensional approach; thirdly, why is it important to include urban poor in the public policy making to empower them and make them feel part of the city and why the state should be one of the main stakeholders through urban interventions in the processes to help people get out of poverty. The other fixed stakeholder that should be involved is the community in order to achieve a real change in the situation. There are some potential actors such as the private sector or NGOs, which could help throughout this process, but are not indispensable as the other two.

2.A Slum-Upgrading processes to bridge the inequality gap – An institutional and an acupuncture approach

There are several ways to define a slum. UN-HABITAT (2003b) defines them as areas lacking public services with houses built with low-standards or in an illegal way, and structures with an inadequate construction, overcrowded and with high-density. Slums are located in risk zones, with insecurity of tenure and informal settlements (ibid). Cities Alliance describes slums as:

"Neglected parts of cities where housing and living conditions are appallingly poor. Slums range from high density, squalid central city tenements to spontaneous squatter settlements without legal recognition or rights, sprawling at the edge of cities" (www.citiesalliances.org)

The vast majority of slum dwellers are economically attached to the informal sector inside the slum itself or in other areas of the city (UN-HABITAT, 2003b).

There is no doubting the great need to have effective interventions in slum upgrading at a wide scale. Since slums have many problems to be solve, planners need to envision policies and solutions to tackle the real scale of the problem. Therefore, slum-upgrading processes need to be able to be implemented at a broader scale of intervention. The process of scaling up could be defined as the one that encompasses "expanding, adapting and sustaining successful policies, programs or projects in different places and over time to reach a greater number of people" (Hartmann & Linn, 2008 P: 14). The goal is to incorporate as many people as possible into a positive dynamic (e.g. economically, socially and of wellbeing) and provide them with opportunities enabling them to be more productive. The merging of housing policies with the neo-liberal growth patterns from which many developed and developing countries are suffering from, requires an urgent need to understand alternative, non-conventional housing-policy approaches.

The rapid economic growth of Colombia is presenting challenges in bridging the gap between the rich and the poor. The GINI index of the country is 0,55 for the year 2011, one of the highest in the world (www.worldbank.org). This document is looking for effective approaches for slum upgrading and housing to increase justice and lead to greater

equity. As Pugh claims, every improvement in the immediate life quality and the physical environment inside informal settlements accelerate the positive process of the dweller when an upgrading program is launched (2000). In brief, the aim is to use the upgrading process as a catalyst to change the dynamics of life of slum dwellers, and in a way to reach scale in the proposed interventions.

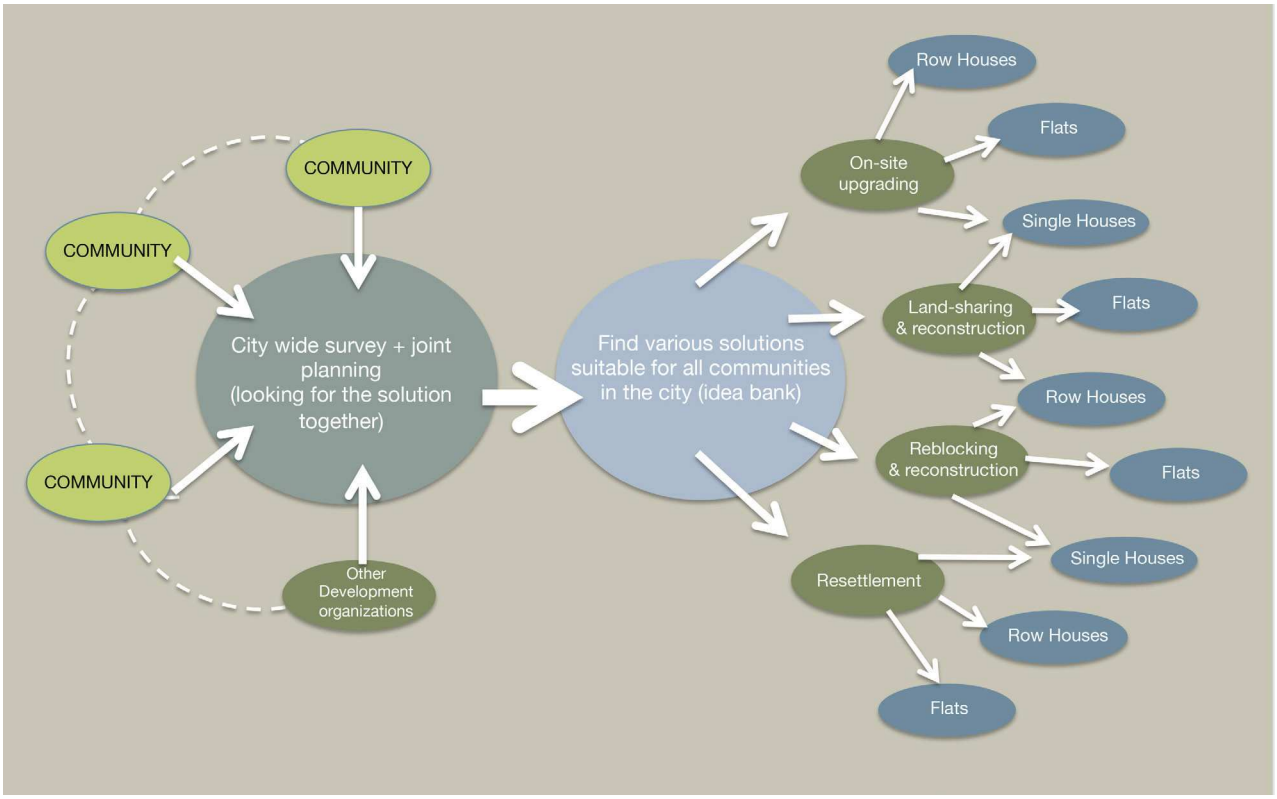
Every city should provide their citizens an optimal scenario to allow them to prosper and develop properly. As Borja (citation needed) presented, the "derecho a la ciudad" (right to the city) should contain legal rights and with it: security of tenure; housing affordability; provision of community buildings for social services and welfare; public space; and accessibility to public transportation to access other services of the city. The whole process should be firmly linked to socioeconomic and political rights in order to provide equal conditions to all citizens (2012). Many scholars and academics offer many reasons why this problem should be tackled in a multidimensional way. In reality, many governments, the Colombian included, tackle all these aspects of poverty in a silo approach. There are different programs inside local and national entities with similar goals but different approaches (e.g. economic – Ministry of Finance or Secretary of Finance, physical – Ministry of Housing or Secretary of Planning, transportation – Ministry of Transport or Secretary of Mobility and public services – Ministry of Housing – EAAB and CODENSA). The aim is to have all of them work together towards the same goal in a joint-up approach.

As a possible approach to the problem, Patel et al. suggest that public agencies should propose a regulatory method for more integral solutions incorporating all stakeholders into one system (2011). Acknowledging that every slum contains specific situations and problems, all processes should be as flexible as possible and adaptable for various situations (ibid). A good example of an innovative government institution, which encompasses many of these aspects under the same umbrella, is the Thai governmental branch, CODI. This is the first model of a state's effective involvement in urban issues around poverty. It is due to political will that Thailand launched a pioneer programme "Baan Mankong" in 2007 through CODI. It is managed by CODI, a semi-independent government institution tasked with set-up of the programme and dealing with all its aspects (ibid). Its principal aims are to upgrade slums physically and legally and to empower the community through financial programs (Boonyabancha 2009). CODI acts as an intermediary between slum dwellers and different entities of the state, and among the entities themselves (ibid.). To be able to achieve this substantial institutional change, the national institutions need to acknowledge the importance of having a holistic approach to address poverty issues.

Box 1. CODI – an institutional approach

The Urban Community Development Office (UCDO), predecessor of CODI, was first created by the Thai government in the year 1992 to address poverty issues after recognizing economics success of the 1980s-1990s had brought little benefit to the poor. The rapid economic progress period led to massive urban growth and an informal settlement growth from rural-urban migration of people looking for better economic opportunities. It also led to a bigger threat of land evictions for private development projects in well-located land. UCDO had the budget to provide loans at a very low interest rate to organized communities. They would then be able to invest it in activities like land acquisition, housing construction or improvement, communal buildings among others.

After ensuring that the communities were paying back the loans and more communities were participating in the programme, UCDO decided support the process and replicate it in several communities all over the country. Also because the organization was acting in the role of an NGO, addressing every single and specific problem for every community. This is when the community networks started



GRAPH 1.

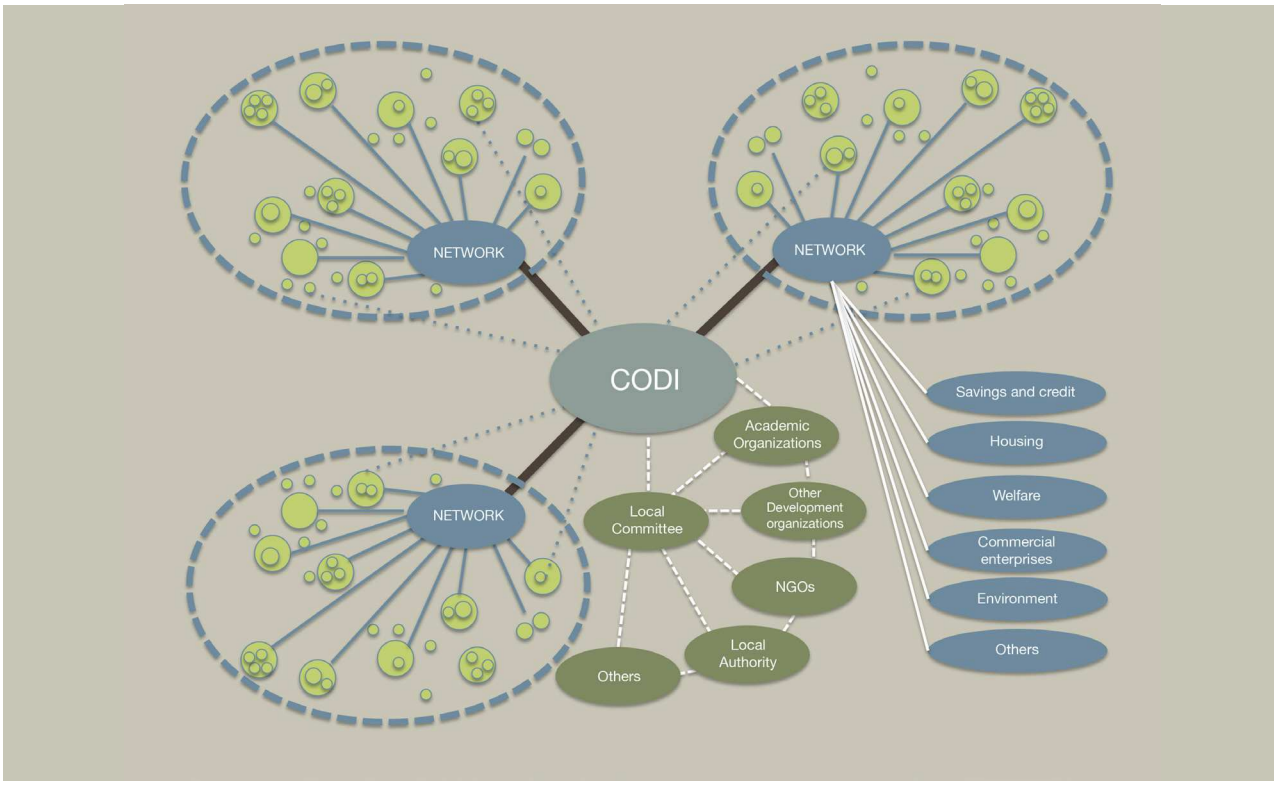
to play a very important role. The loans began being lent to the networks and they became responsible for the debt of the communities. This step also led to increased communication of communities within the same region. The exchange of knowledge, ideas and problems took the programme to a different level of cooperation and scale. The communities became more powerfully united to negotiate with provincial or city authorities and landlords, and in having a bigger influence in the decision-making process of new planning processes.

In the year 2000, when UCDO was merged with the Rural Development Fund to generate the Community Organizations Development Institute, CODI, there were 950 community savings groups established. This provided coverage of 53 from the 76 provinces the country is divided in. Furthermore, at least 100 community networks were setup at that moment. The new institute embraced the UCDO programmes but has legal independence within the governmental structure. This enables CODI to have greater flexibility as an independent institution with wider linkages and the possibility to apply for funds annually. Both organizations have a Board including governmental and community representatives.

CODI and its predecessor UCDO have had an impact in 277 cities reaching all Thai provinces (76), and 1,546 communities over the last 20 years. This shows an institutional stamina where imagination, innovation and political will during a considerable period of time were triggers for a real change in the society.

(Boonyabancha, 2003; www.codi.or.th)

GRAPH 1. CODI HOUSING ALLOCATION. SOURCE: BOONYABANCHA, 2003



GRAPH 2.

Nevertheless many countries in the global south are fortunately experiencing this positive change in a gradual manner. In Colombia, for instance, the *Agencia Nacional para la Superación de la Pobreza Extrema* (ANSPE) is a national institution created in 2011 to tackle extreme poverty only. This agency works with the 1.5 million poorest families in the country in order to help them out of poverty. They need to achieve 45 goals designed by the agency to be able to overcome the poverty traps. The UNIDOS Programme is the framework the ANSPE has with nine main action fronts:

1. Identification (survey)
2. Income and job type
3. Education
4. Health
5. Nutrition
6. Habitability
7. Family dynamic
8. Access to banking services (saving)

GRAPH 2. CODI'S METHODOLOGY. SOURCE: BOONYABANCHA, 2003

9. Access to justice

The families have a 5-year accompaniment process followed by consultations with '*cogestores*' (social workers) to be sure the families are meeting the goals periodically (ANSPE, 2013). This umbrella institution clusters private and public entities around the involved people in the programme to tackle each family's issues individually and promptly (ibid). In order to raise awareness and show the reality of everyday life to the country's leaders, the ANSPE led the '*cogestor por un día*' (social worker for one day) programme, where ministers and political leaders were supposed to do the daily job of a '*cogesor*' for a workday. This exercise changed the mind frame of the people who were taking the major decisions in terms of annual budget in the central government. After that, the ANSPE gained more recognition and respect within the cabinet and as a result, more credibility and funds to change the life of poor Colombians.

Finally, the most important aspect to this type of holistic approach is to increase impact and scale. It should go further than just formulating independent projects or the proliferation of individual cases. The quality of each intervention is much more important than the quantity of cases in a city ensuring integration and inclusion.Integration depends fundamentally upon processes of participation, partnership and devolution which give diverse social groups the power to make decisions that influence their lives and environments, and thus it is intimately tied to processes of institutional reform" (Fiori *et al.*, 2000 p19). Furthermore is an immense possibility and responsibility for housing and slum-upgrading policies to foster change from a multisectorial perspective in all scales (local, city-wide and regional) (Fiori and Ramirez, 1992). Moreover, to reach scale it is necessary to impact and transform the local and national institutions. As highlighted above, it could be only possible by creating programs, which include economic, social and political aspects in their interventions. It is also crucial to incorporate within spatial interventions social features such as employment, education and access to (Mosel, 1995).

Many cities in Latin America are encouraging other types of interventions for slum-upgrading processes. The urban projects have become "main character" and catalyst in many deprived areas from Medellín, Caracas and São Paulo. The main characteristic of these projects is their multi-programmatic way of tackling different scales of the problem with a sole intervention (e.g. accessibility, education, culture, health, employment etc.). Colombian cities like Bogotá or Medellín since the 1980's understood the importance to generate 'seed' projects as an alternative to change the dynamic of the informal settlements in the city (Romero, 1989). The main idea is to optimise the few, and disperse assistance the local governments allocate to informal settlements.

Box 2.
Medellín MetroCable an acupuncture approach

In order to contextualize the acupuncture approach to urban transformation, the city of Medellín is presented. Medellín is the second largest city of Colombia and a very important industrial city. Unfortunately, Medellín is also known as the 'murder capital' because of a violent period in the late 1980s from the drugs-war.
Since the 1980s Medellín has been focused in the development of policies to bridge the f inequality gap Colombian cities have. Inclusionary and upgrading policies like PRIMED and the "*Projecto Urbano Integral*" (PUI) are some examples of the city's effort. The PUI is a programme developed between 2004 and 2007, during Mayor Fajardo's administration, to fight social exclusion and the problems of informal settlements. Its main components were:

1. **Physical (architecture and urban design projects)**
2. **Social (participation and appropriation of these projects by the community)**
3. **Institutional (coordination of institutions, agencies and programmes within the local administration)**

The physical component is normally comprised of community building (e.g. library, school or clinics) and an improvement of the accessibility of the area (e.g. MetroCable,

stairs, bridges and public space). The most famous intervention is the MetroCable Línea K, which connect to the Santo Domingo Library. This mega library offers several cultural and educational services the community never had before. It has reading rooms, a ludoteca (play room), internet rooms, conference rooms, a business development centre, an auditorium and a museum (RDB, 2013). These interventions generated an enormous impact in the community, which is directly linked with the social component. and social capital

The social component entails the participatory processes and the involvement of the community in the decision-making and the control of the intervention. The channels of communication with the community involved were crucial to the success of the project. This also guaranteed the increase of the sense of belonging and appropriation of the project. It also facilitated opportunities for the community to have better relations with the local authorities, because they felt, finally, the local authorities were investing in the poor (EDU, 2005b cited in Calderón, 2009). Another positive social impact is from openings in the neighbourhoods. These informal settlements are "labyrinths" where the police and other social actors were not able to enter quickly. Security and well-being have increased since the urban projects were established in these neighbourhoods as acupuncture nodes.

Finally the institutional component was responsible to bring all the actors together facilitating the communications and coordination of the whole process. The creation of active inter-institutional and inter-sectoral mechanisms to promote a culture of cooperation among the city's institutions is the main goal of this component. In this case the Empresa de Desarrollo Urbano (EDU) and the PUI team became the main channel for coordination, ensuring optimization and effectiveness. The main idea of these projects is to generate a pointed and strategic positive impact in marginal areas of the city in order to spread the new services to the whole area gradually. The main goal is to deliver non-existing urban services into a specific location to generate the greatest possible impact.

PICURE 1.AND PICTURE 2. LINEA K OF METROCABLE AND SANTO DOMINGO LIBRARY SOURCE: SILVA, 2013

As Lerner explains, urban interventions should occur at strategic focal points, helping the normal processes of planning to work faster (2007). Cities are rapidly growing and their problems are growing with them at the same pace. Planners nowadays do not have any time to typically plan cities constantly changing, in a slowly evolving manner. This alternative seeks the allocation of urban projects with high impact whose evolution progresses with the evolution of communities. This process has been described as 'Urban Acupuncture'. To give a better idea of the term, it could be compared with the traditional Chinese medicinal treatment, where "the most critical point [is recognised], using the smallest effort to get the maximum body condition and achieve maximum efficiency. Urban Acupuncture takes the city as a living body, grasping the whole vein of the city in the process of urban regeneration and growth, it will activate its potential and promote the city's development " (Shidan and Qian 2011 p1859,)

2.B. Why is it important to design policies for poverty in a Multiple dimensional way?

During the 1970s and 1980s and even in the early 1990s, housing, living conditions, public service provision and infrastructure were issues unlinked to poverty. Throughout this time period, governments and international agencies

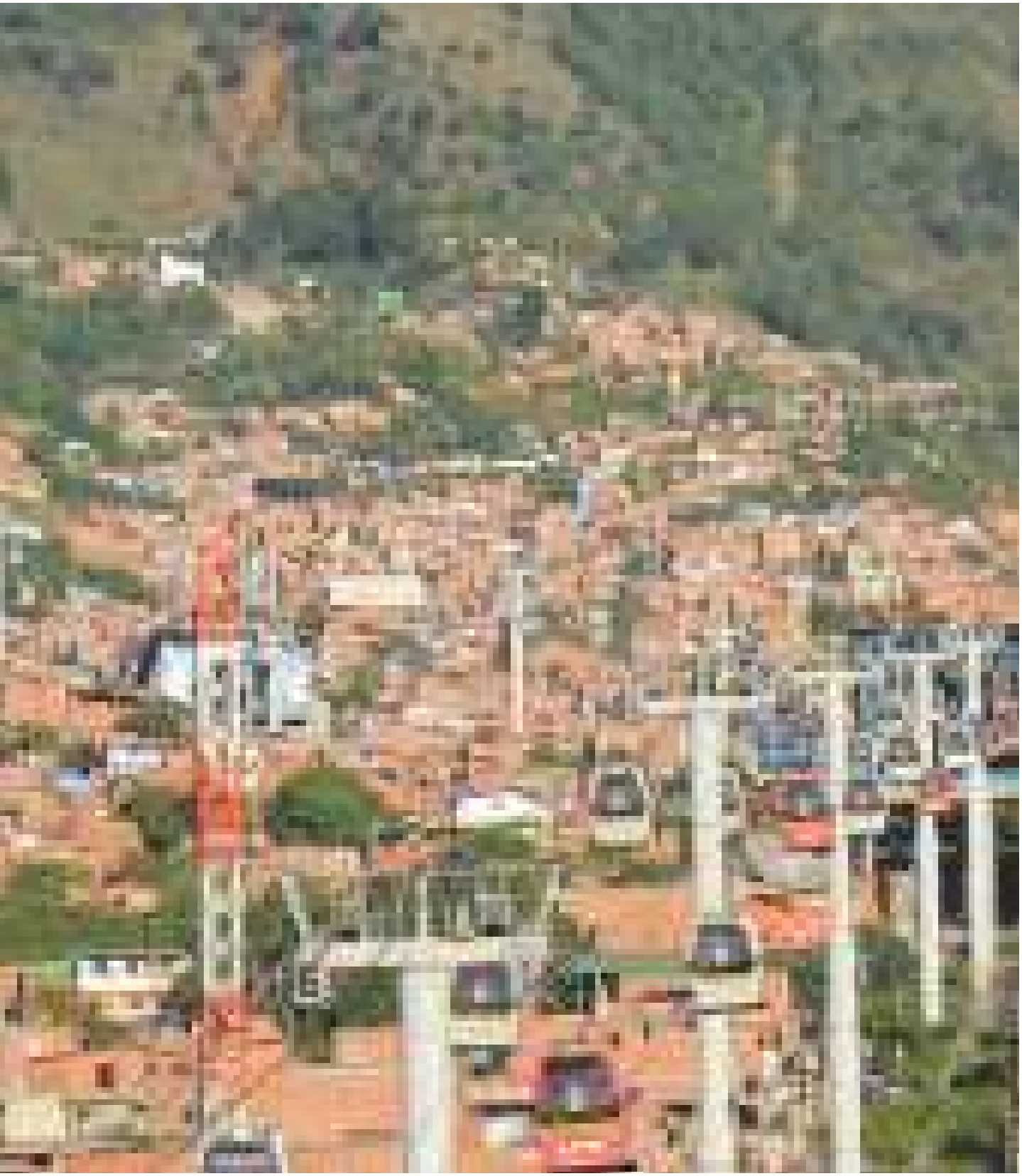


PICTURE 2. LINEA K OF METROCABLE AND SANTO DOMINGO LIBRARY SOURCE: SILVA, 2013





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2.B Why is it important to design policies for poverty in a Multiple dimensional way?

During the 1970s and 1980s and even in the early 1990s, housing, living conditions, public service provision and infrastructure were issues unlinked to poverty. Throughout this time period, governments and international agencies measured poverty lines based on income or consumption levels instead of incorporating deprivation aspects such as housing and living conditions, lack of civil and political rights, basic services or education (Mitlin and Satterthwaite, 2003). It was first in 1994 when the non-income aspects of poverty started to be discussed in the planning sphere. Particularly Amartya Sen, with his book "Development as Freedom" (1999), was one of the main contributors to this new framework to treat poverty (ibid). Sen argues poverty should be seen as the "deprivation of basic capabilities rather than merely as lowness of income" (2001 p 87). Furthermore Sen claims that capabilities are only one of two concepts to assess well-being; 'functionings' is the second one (1996). "Capabilities are the freedoms people have to achieve the kinds of lives they have reason to value. Those states of doing or being is, which people value from Sen terms as 'functionings'" (Frediani, 2010). In this sense it is very important to assess correctly where the change is taking place. If the target community is upgrading its capabilities but has no scenario to put that in practice, the process will not be holistic and will not generate a tangible change. In order to foster human capabilities, public policies should take into account five perspectives (Sen, 1999):

Colombia started the process to frame poverty with multidimensional indicators in the late 1980s. As a result of the unsatisfactory performance of previous indictors, the Colombian government developed the Colombian Multidimensional Poverty Index (CMPI) in 2010. This was to allow for measurement of the actual living conditions in the country and to design appropriate public policies to reduce poverty (Angulo *et al.*, 2013). The new index includes the following five dimensions: "education of household members; childhood and youth conditions; health; employment; and access to household utilities and living conditions" (ibid, p3.). All these conditions are crucial to be addressed in public policy making, including housing and slum-upgrading policies. Fiori *et al*. acknowledge the complexity of poverty and the need for a multidimensional approach because: poverty is affected by many conditions (e.g. cultural, local and social) and by their gender, age, ethnic origin and abilities (2000). They also argue "the condition of poverty is lived by the poor in such a variety of forms that it becomes nearly impossible to define a concept of poverty, and a strategy for its eradication, without the participation of the poor themselves in these process" (ibid, p11). It is very important to have a holistic view and approach to poverty. In cases where programmes and policies do not have this manner to assess poverty, the problem can hardly be solved. It is demonstrated that with solely housing provision, the cycle of poverty will not be overcome. It requires additional dimensions including employment, infrastructure, health, community participation

GRAPH 3.



GRAPH 3. PERSPECTIVES TO UPGRADE CAPABILITIES. SOURCE: SEN, 1999, TURNER, 1972, JIRÓN 2010

and trainings among other things (Jirón, 2010).

Having the family unit as the main target including all individuals, the house becomes the site of many of their activities. As Hernández and Kellett argue, there is now an acknowledgement of housing as a human right. There is a need for policies, not only to provide shelter but also to improve the urban poor's livelihoods. This is due to the link between low-income housing generation and income generation, as well as enablement of the informal sector activities to appear with the intervention (2010).

One of the most well-known proponents of this model is the British architect, John Turner, who worked and conducted research for many years in Latin America. Turner believes housing should be understood as a verb rather than as a noun or object. "Understanding housing as an action and seeing the values in the roles procedures and products play in people's lives" (Turner 1972, p174). As housing depends on its actors' actions (dwellers), these actors must be free to take any decision, which suits their priorities in the best way possible. If these conditions are not met it is very difficult for urban dwellers to use their house as a vehicle to get them out of poverty. The previous processes around housing described in graph 3 are crucial when a household provides a path out of poverty. In many circumstances, informal settlements are progressively consolidating not only the shacks or temporary houses but also the whole neighbourhood. In this process a community is being built in parallel of the physical upgrading of the infrastructure and the built environment (Kellett, 2005). This is the most important process, to build a community.

2.C Citizenship and Empowerment of a community; how to make vulnerable people feel part of the society

Every city should deliver a platform to enable a sense of community, however instead it provides a situation, which creates a polarized society instead and where social exclusion has become the tendency. "Social exclusion refers to the social relations and organisational barriers that block the attainment of livelihoods, human development, and equal citizenship" (Beall and Piron, 2005). As Lefebvre argues, every citizen has many rights such as health, security, recreation and employment (1996). When an individual fulfils these needs it means the society in which this individual lives is socially just. He/she can exercise his/her right as a citizen. Although every city should give the tools to its citizens and provide the ideal scenario to build sense of community, it often generates a polarized society, with massive inequalities and social exclusion. Therefore participation should be one of the main strategies used to bridge this gap. It should be used to tackle both issues from marginal groups and also from every part of the society to shape a social just city. In order facilitate a decision-making process, which accounts for every part of the society, it is vital to have a just representation of their common interests (Sandercock, 1998). Therefore, the most important issue is to include participatory processes and to incorporate everyone in order to cross the barriers of segregation and exclusion in every level (e.g. ethnicity, race, class, gender) (Ibid). The real meaning of participation should be the empowerment of the community, real access to transformation and inclusion. The city provides the best scenario to make this (ibid). As Lefebvre states, it is impossible to go back to traditional urban approaches ("towards the traditional city") in todays' problematic of these shapeless agglomerations called cities (1996). Planners have to engage with their creative and innovative side to come up with more appropriate programmes and policies to incorporate society's marginal people to truly solve their problems. People need to contribute in every part of the process, to be the core of it.

Additionally, Fainstein argues, that the achievement of several values like equality, diversity and democracy within an already divided society should be included in every planning agenda (1996). Likewise Holston claims that democracy has promised to reach a more egalitarian citizenship that encompasses greater justice and dignity among differences within a community (2008).

"The formal qualifications and

> substantive distributions of citizens that define a particular formulation ultimately depend on the meanings of equality and inequality they embody. All citizenships manage the social differences of citizens according to their underlying meanings" (**HOLSTON, 2008: P25**).

Hence almost all democratic states and cities are creating in practice a vast conflict among their citizens (Holston, 2008). Generally, they fail and create prejudice in the distribution of opportunities, security and even rights. All in all, a social just city should properly recognize the citizenship of all their inhabitants (e.g. obligations and rights), but mostly it should deliver equal opportunities to everyone. This is the successful mechanism to incorporate people into the planning processes.

2.D Physical transformation towards a tangible social change

In order to recognise a previously discriminated group, the whole society should experience a transformation process of several aspects. These include transforming its social and cultural urban life, and promoting coexistence and tolerance in order to change their status of disrespect, domination and inequality. This transformation process should foster political changes in order to represent it in the public realm and the urban space (Lima and Pallamin, 2010). These changes require a very difficult, but crucial rethinking of the policy approach and the way the state authorities manage this delicate topic. It is important to start many social processes with a physical transformation. By changing the material face, the preconceived notions of the zone in analysis from other citizens have been altered. These processes create new gaps into the inflexible political sphere, making evident the needs of the people and their capabilities. Here the insurgent movements and the participatory process find an opportunity to be one of the protagonists in a new and innovative way of planning.

There are many different forms of transformation. It can be defined as both physical and social improvements towards social capital. Shatkin claims that social transformation needs the involvement and empowerment of poor women and men through capacity building and "self-transformation," and the transformation of urban governance and institutions towards social justice in both institutional and distributional dimensions (2007). Under spatial transformation, the physical environment where communities live is supposed to change and improve, ideally, including the design and planning of infrastructure and housing (2007). These types of processes normally occur in already consolidated areas and the process can take into account and confront the already existing situation of 'tabula rasa'. Greene and Rojas advocate that informal settlements should be upgrades in a 'respectful' way, in order to emphasize and enhance the existing fabric and situation rather than impose a new design in the already existing parts of the city (2010). It is important to highlight the relevance of the already existing territory and to utilize the virtues of the existing situation in solving the problems of the community. In many cases the problems are bigger that the opportunities, but there is always positive aspects to rescue and maximize to help change the dynamic of people's live in a positive way.

Moreover, social transformation involves participatory process in order to empower communities through building their capacities (e.g. education, technical support or trainings). Individual transformation involves the skills community members gained throughout the participatory processes, and most importantly the application of these skills into their real life and other aspects of livelihoods. Finally, institutional transformation involves an enhanced environment for participation inside state institutions. This reinforces institutional capacities and maintains the sustainability of the already existing institutional performance, in partnership with the new people-centred processes for wider social transformation. These three areas of transformation are direct linked to the five perspectives represented in graph 4, where holistic institutions, employment, social services, community participation and equity are recognised as the core aspects to address in public policies concerning poverty.

In bringing together all the concepts mentioned above, it is important to highlight that the role of the state is crucial not only in taking the initiative

3 Analytical f`ework

but also in the implementation of innovative housing policies that could solve or contribute in the poverty problem in urban centres. Having an obvious situation of lack of opportunities including proper health facilities, education and a closed labour market, the probability of having community leaders capable of changing a whole communities' situation is seldom possible. This is the main reason why the State has the major responsibility to create the spaces and opportunities to foster a meaningful change in deprived communities. Hence, as Fiori and Ramirez claim,

> "The merge from housing policies with the neo-liberal growth patterns that many developed and developing countries are suffering converges in an urgent need to understand the non-conventional housing-policy approaches. Normally these innovative proposals do not fit in the normative frameworks from where they emerge"
> **(FIORI AND RAMIREZ, 1992: 24).**

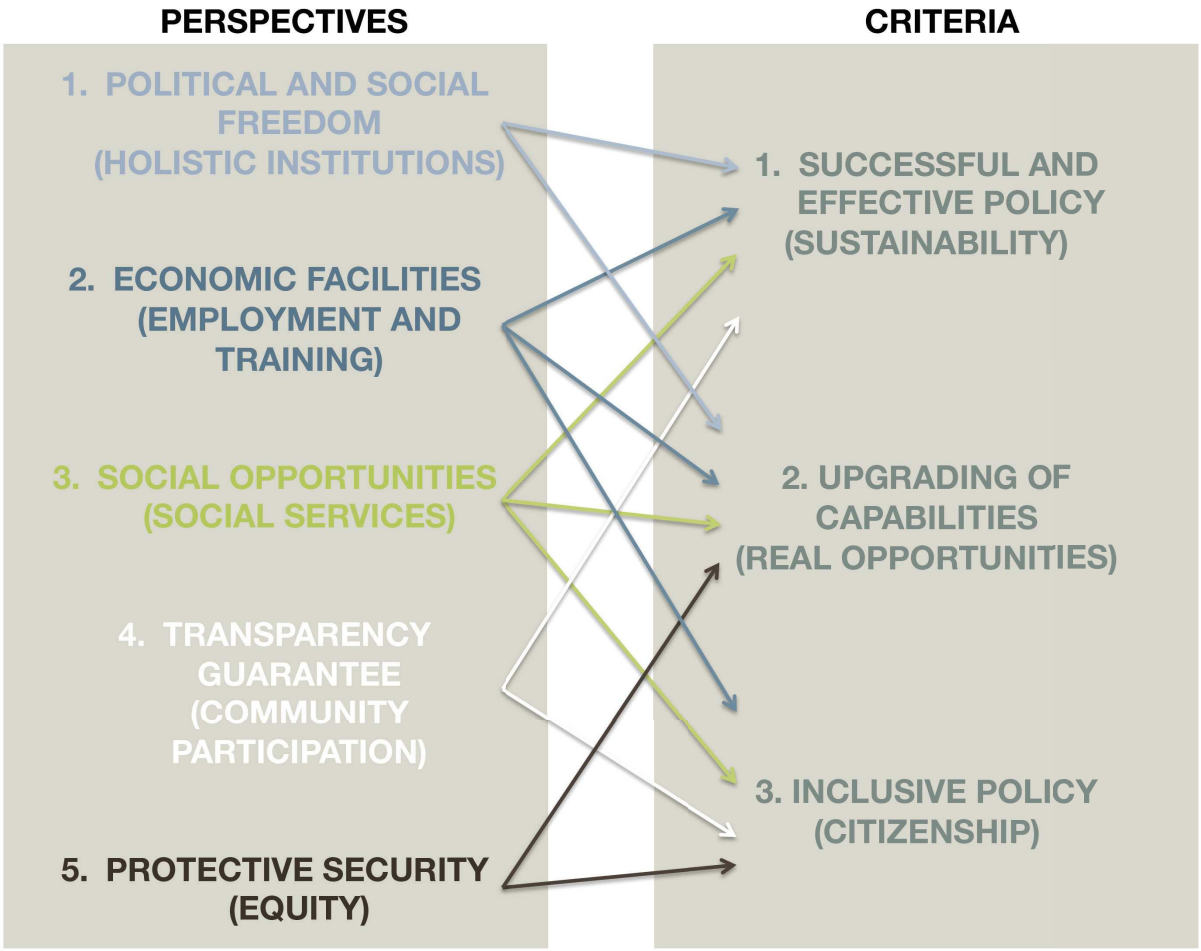
In the next chapter there will be three criteria proposed to be able to assess the case study. As graph 4, shows, they are directly derived from the five perspectives Sen proposes.

The chapter presents the criteria of success and efficacy around institutions and policies; and how transformative they are towards the individual, institutions and for the social environment (community). It also provides an assessment of the community's capability to achieve their rights, upgrade their actual situation, and reach their needs.

PERSPECTIVES CRITERIA

3.A A successful and

GRAPH 4.



GRAPH 4 PERSPECTIVES AND CRITERIA. SOURCE: SEN, 1999 AND TURNER 1972

effective policy

Hartmann and Linn state that a scaling-up project should be incorporated into a policy, with sufficient and sustainable impact to be called a successful one. (2008). Furthermore, these policies should have a replicable universal component and yet provide room for local adaptation to every case's potentials and threats. The authors identified four key factors that a successful scaling-up policy should have: enabling leadership among the community, managing political constituencies, ensuring supportive policies, and developing the institutional capacity for these policies to have continuity. Following the multidimensional concept, an efficient policy should be strategically designed to capitalize all the efforts in achieving the desired outcomes. In order to have a successful and effective policy, it should, firstly, come from a holistic institution, incorporating various sectors such as economical, social, cultural and physical. Secondly, it needs to provide an optimistic scenario to trigger possibilities for more employment, by either providing the space or the training to do so. Thirdly, the basic services (e.g. health, education, public services) must be already provided for within the area . Finally, it is preferable to have a participatory process acknowledging the community and its necessities. As Crocker claims, "what people value…participatory methods are needed to reveal people's aspirations and their freedom to achieve them" (2007, cited in Frediani, 2010)

3.B Up-grading capabilities – providing real opportunities

In order to be able to assess the types of areas a programme is providing to the community Sen's capability approach is being introduced.

> "The capability approach to a person's advantage is concerned with evaluating it in terms of his or her actual ability to achieve various valuable functioning as a part of living. The corresponding approach to social advantage – for aggregative appraisal as well as for the choice of institutions and policy – takes the set of individual capabilities as constituting an indispensable and central part of the relevant informational base of such evaluation" (Sen 1993: 30).

As explained in the previous chapter, Sen argues that, in order to provide the ideal conditions to help people get out of poverty, policies must foster change from diverse angles. Social opportunities such as education and health, and access to employment and training of technical skills should be tackled with the same intensity as the physical or legal aspects of housing. Likewise, the inhabitants need to be in a secure place, where they can fulfil all their needs without any obstacles or threats. Holistic institutions of the local and national levels should provide all that. As Deneulin and Stewart argue, "development is about providing conditions which facilitate people's ability to lead flourishing lives" (2002: 62 cited in Frediani, 2010). Nonetheless, all the resources and their transformation into achievable opportunities can be tangible (e.g. transport, schools or houses) or non-tangible (e.g. policies). These series of functions tend to be personal but there are communal functions, which need to be tackled as well. These change however depending on their transformational resources, context and person or community involved (Frediani, 2010).

3.C An inclusive policy towards citizenship

Since the dominant neoliberal world seeks legitimacy through democracy promoting political inclusion, it really is avoiding redistribution and equity. Miraftab proposes that neo-liberal governments should include participatory and inclusive structures (policies), including citizens' collective action, advocating for citizenship (2009). Furthermore, finding scenarios to introduce the appropriate dialogue towards inclusion, both sides (community and government entity) should foster a reciprocal respect and trust. This is in order to reach consensus in strategic aspects with the communities' involvement (Healey, 1999).

4 Case Study – UPZ67 *El Lucero*

> "This relation-building and identity-creation work can be witnessed in many of the 'partnership' and 'empowerment' initiatives in contemporary subnational governance. In effect, where such processes bind together new groupings of people in the course of a governance initiative, they generate new 'cultural resources' for the participants, a form of 'cultural capital' or 'social capital'"
> **(IBID, P.114)**



GRAPH 5.

Case Study – UPZ67 El Lucero, the ideal cluster to apply a successful Upgrading Policy

4.A History of Planning tendencies in Bogotá

Slum landscapes, rapid urbanization and poverty are common in Colombian cities. where The urban population is 32.319.000 (75.5%) of the total population of the country (42.803.000). Additionally, 21.8% of these urban dwellers, an estimated of 7.057.000, are slum-dwellers (UN-HABITAT, 2003a). Moreover, Colombia has an additional cause for this rapid urban growth. The country has been suffering for more than five decades from a social-political conflict mainly in the rural areas. These continued periods of violence have produced more than 5.000.000 forced internal displacements (IDMC, 2013). As a result, the largest Colombian cities have been forced to accommodate rural migrants in a continually for over fifty years. Bogotá, as the capital of the country, is one of the most appealing urban centres in terms of job acquisition and opportunities.

Bogotá is the capital city of Colombia and its main economic centre. It has 7.674.366 inhabitants and is divided into 19 localities (DANE, SDP, 2007). Bogotá is known to be a city seeking to solve the problems of marginality. The '*Integral Plans*' from the 1970s and 1980s funded by multilateral agencies proposed first to overcome the urban deficiencies (Escallón, 2006). In the late 1980s UNDP launched the programme *"Acciones integradas para el mejoramiento de calidad de vida en los asentamientos populares urbanos" (Integral Actions for life improvement of urban dwellers from informal settlements)* where dialogue between citizens and the state was fostered by the integration of different state entities, NGOs and the civil society. The "*Forming the City*" programme (1995-1997) inside the District Development Plan presented for the first time the *seed* terminology to the planning sphere. Communities were appropriating community buildings in public spaces for the first time (Escallón, 2008). The main target in the *"Obras con Saldo Pedagógico"* ("Works with Pedagogical Output") programme was to provide socially just interventions and start creating the "*city culture"*. The methodology of the programme was to build local scale community buildings through participatory methods integrating the community in the process and achieving the desired impact (ibid). Between 1998 and the year 2000 the "de-marginalisation programme" started with a legalization of more than 1.400 informal neighbourhoods created in the last 40 years. The local authorities additionally

GRAPH 5. LOCATION OF COLOMBIA – BOGOTÁ. SOURCE: (MAPS-CONTINENTS, 2013)

GRAPH 6. COMPARISON OF COLOMBIAN HOUSING AND SLUM-UPGRADING POLICIES WITH THE WORLD SITUATION. SOURCE: (COMPES MIB, 2010) (THE CHALLENGE OF SLUMS, UN-HABITAT, 2003)

implemented infrastructure projects (e.g. new roads, sidewalks, schools) and public services (e.g. water, electricity and sewage) in these neighbourhoods (ibid). Finally, Bogotá adopted in the year 2000 the *Plan de Ordenamiento Territorial* POT (structure plan),[4] where the city was mapped and its guidelines were formulated. The programme '*Mejoramiento Integral de Barrios' (MIB)* (Informal Settlements Upgrading Programme) was one of the programmes included into the normative framework used by planners. The city identified 27 UPZ to be included in the city programmes and to provide services and opportunities in order to achieve a more equal city.

4.B The 'Mejoramiento Integral de Barrios' (MIB) (Informal Settlements Upgrading Programme) as a planning tool to enable change.

The MIB is a programme within the city's legal framework, with the capacity to identify the necessities and opportunities of the marginal areas not only in Bogotá, but also in other Colombian cities. The MIB programme acknowledges that the sectorial solutions are incapable of offering sustainable and acceptable conditions to overcome poverty. This programme also focuses more in qualitative factors rather than in just quantitative (García *et al.,* 2009). The main goal is to shift from an

GRAPH 6.

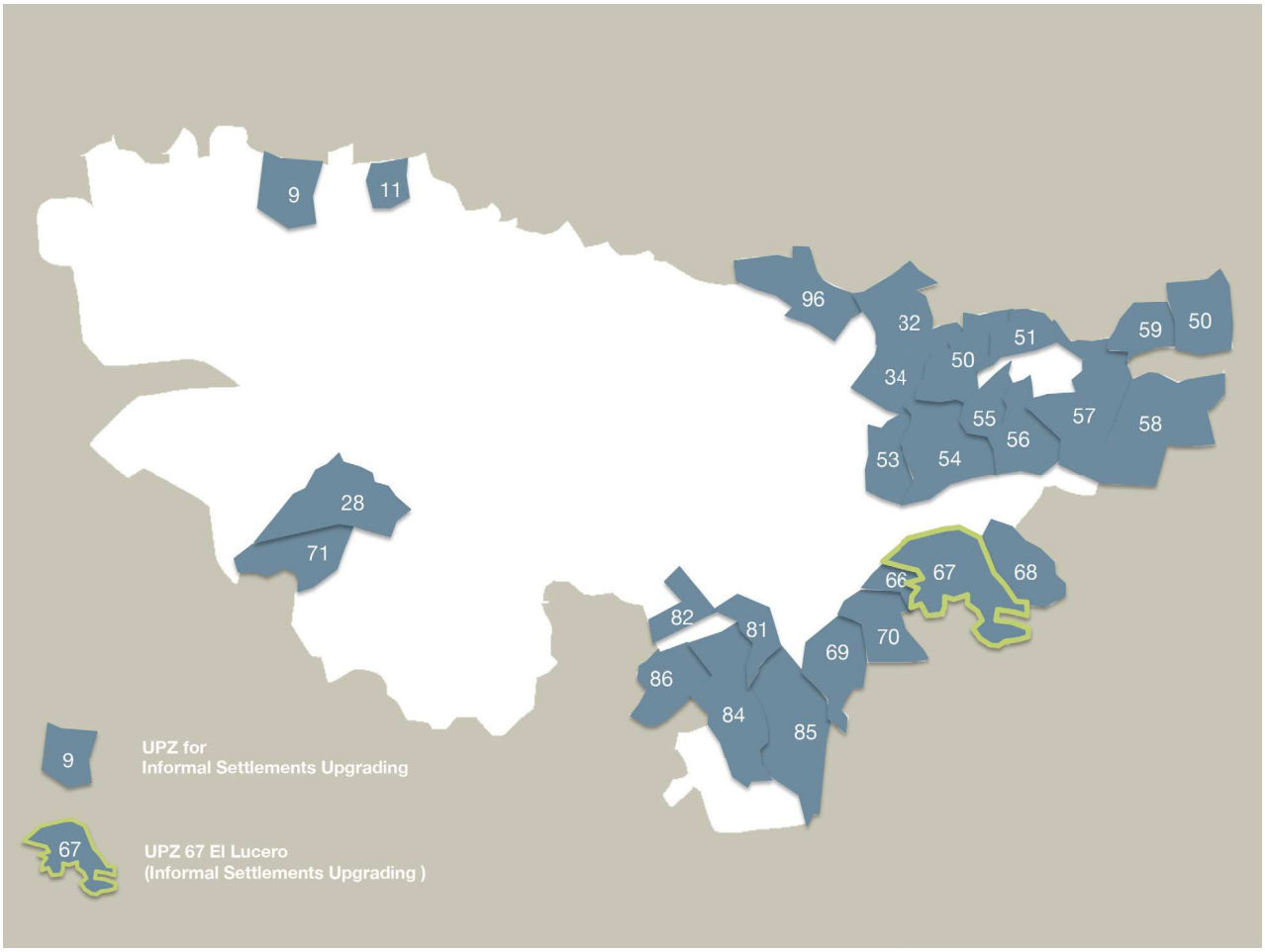


[4] The Plan de Ordenamiento Territorial (POT) is the Structure Plan Enrique Peñalosa, major between 1998-2000, developed first the 28th of July 2000 (SDP, 2011). The document includes the normative and legal framework of the city (urban - rural rules) and a set of 34 maps where different type of information can be consulted, such as the uses and urban treatments the city has and is allowed to construct in every specific plot of the city.

individual welfare system in each sector to an inter-sectoral holistic approach tackling social, economic, physical and environmental issues in a sustainable manner. The MIB also suggests that some of the governmental efforts should be transferred from new housing production to the already established residential areas with problems like structural stability, security of tenure and flexibility in the land market. It also analyses how the adaptability of designs and constructive techniques that enhance the local style of life and priorities. Likewise the city's efforts should be focused in the allocation of public services, infrastructure (i.e. public transportation) and social services including economic activities (ibid). Working with an intermediate scale, it is easier to survey, map, and identify the actual situation of these zones and their necessities. As explained above, Bogotá is divided in 117 UPZs and 27 of them are recognized to need a special treatment for slum upgrading (See Graph 7).

Another aim of the UPZ is to identify the already existing situation of many informal but consolidated areas in the city, in order to analyse

GRAPH 7.



them and acknowledge the priorities of the zone, and its potentials and risks (Escallón, 2008). Moreover, the Decree no. 619 de 2.000 (MIB) recognises specific polygons of "restructuring modality" (PMR) with accessibility, spatial, economic and/or cultural potential to act as trigger points for the informal settlement (POT, 2004). The 116 PMR, located in the 27 UPZs of the MIB, allow for more than 700 Ha inside consolidated urban informal areas. This corresponds to nearly the 30% of the urban area of the city, a great opportunity to foster change

GRAPH 7. UPZS OF THE MIB PROGRAMME. SOURCE SDP, 2011

towards a more equal city. The *Suba, Bosa and Ciudad Bolívar* Localities total 52% of these designated areas (Escallón, 2008).

Ciudad Bolívar is one of the twenty *Localidades* of Bogotá and it is the most affected one in terms of poverty, force displacement and informal activities (RCB, 2004). The inhabitants of Ciudad Bolívar are classified in the strata scale 1t and 2 (from 1 to 6, 1 been the poorer and 6 been the richer). This *Localidad* is not only stigmatised as the poorest of the city, but also as the most dangerous one. Almost 70% of the territory is located in the *cerros* (hilly area of Bogotá's valley). It is divided in 8 UPZs having in total 3.237,87 Ha (*ibid.*). The whole *Localidad* is part of the MIB programme, meaning that the area is marginal and has unsatisfied basic needs, lack of public space, community buildings and public services.

Furthermore, this area, among other *Localidades* in a similar situation and with similar problems, has a prioritization status in the city's authorities. Investments in public transport and accessibility should take these areas into account at the onset of planning future interventions in order to achieve major impact. Another option for these areas is that in already consolidated zones with dramatic lack of space, the city provide the framework inside the *POT* to acquire land to develop projects to provide different types of services to the community (e.g. mobility, educational, cultural, recreational, for the wellbeing). As Turner argues:

> "Housing is a composite good that provides a heterogeneous mix of services (…). These services are varied, including neighbourhood amenities, access to education and health facilities, and security, in addition to shelter… and on access to employment and other income-earning opportunities, public facilities, community services, and markets"
> **(1976, P.30; IN MCCALLUM & BENJAMIN, 1985, P.278).**

These polygons are perfect locations for urban projects providing multiple solutions to the community through multi-sectoral interventions. This is to transform the dynamics of the informal settlements and it dwellers in a gradual manner towards their path out of poverty.

> "Multisectoriality is understood as the formu–lation and implementation of programmes and projects that simultaneously integrate the actions of many of the traditional sectors that have hitherto divided the work of public and private agencies. Various dimensions of poverty such as poor housing, limited access to health and educational services, vulnerability to crime, insecure and low incomes"
> **(FIORI, RILEY & RAMIREZ, 2000).**

Here the successful dynamic of CODI could be well applicable, since there is no much free space in these consolidated neighbourhoods. Communities could be re-blocked or upgraded in-situ to free land to allocate the public services and upgrades their houses at the same time. This is the perfect scenario for a participatory process to appear.

4.C The UPZ67 *El Lucero* and the future Metro Cable implementation – The best scenario to apply an effective slum-upgrading policy

The UPZ67 El Lucero is one of the 27 UPZs for *Informal Settlements Upgrade* purposes. It has 181.191 inhabitants, 13.597 housing units and 52.481 households, which means there are 1.4 households per housing unit and 4.4 persons per family (POT, 2006). It is located in the Ciudad Bolívar locality, one of the poorest localities in Bogotá, with a very strong history of violence, drug related problems, and poverty. The vast majority, if not the totality of the UPZ's are constructions of informal origins. It is one of the zones in Bogotá with lower income per capita and an unsatisfactory level of basic needs (UBN) (Alcaldía Mayor de Bogotá, 2004). In the Decree 440 of 2004 the city states that there are 7 PMR and one of them is located in the ecological corridor of the "*Limas*" creek (See Graph 9.).

These polygons aim to contribute to bridging the poverty gap from two angles. Firstly from the structural function and services, their goal is



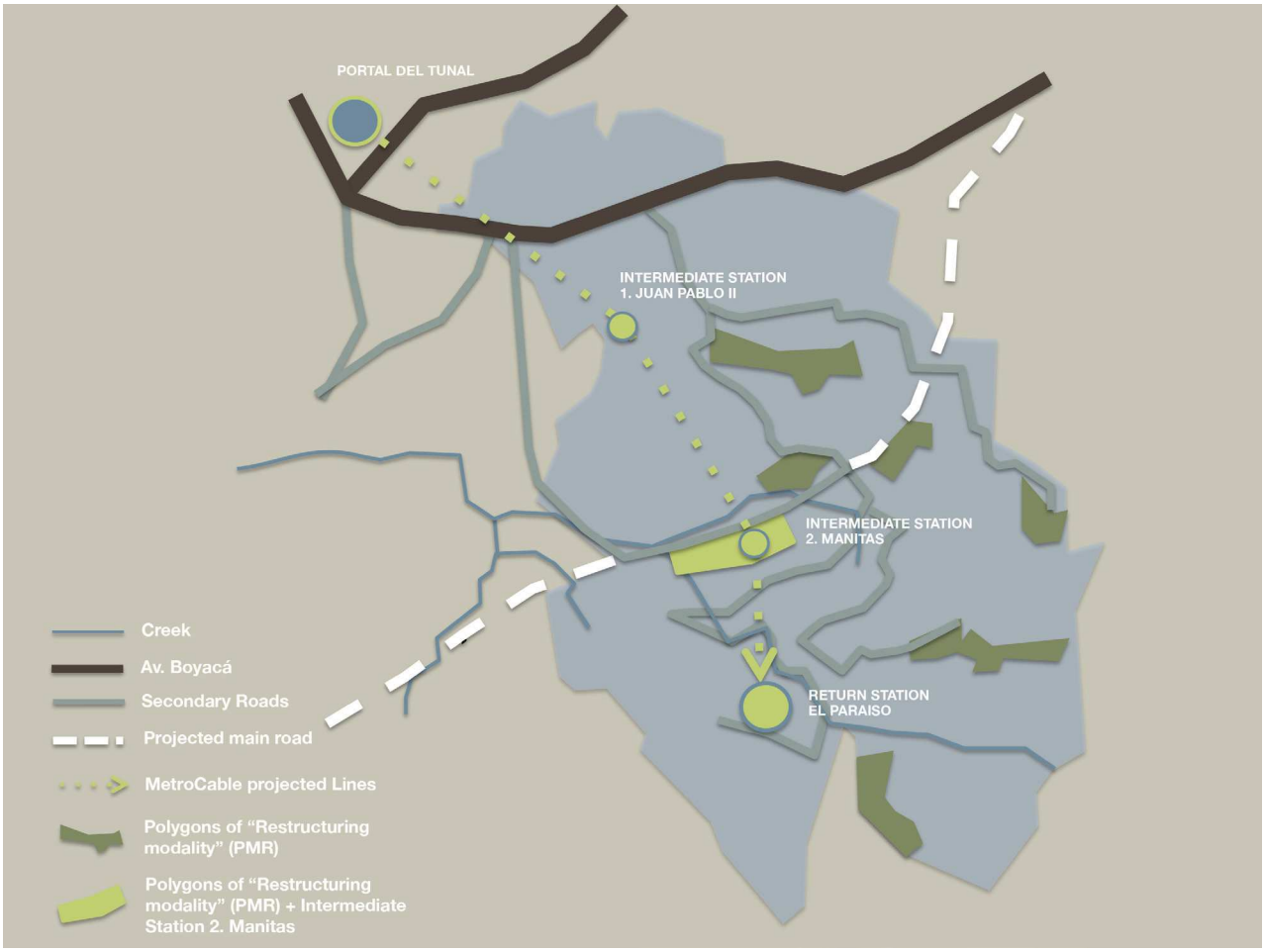
to generate strategic areas for Zonal integration and the location of public facilities. This includes consolidating the mobility system and connecting the whole UPZ and city through the *Portal Usme – TransMilenio BRT*[5] (See Graph 8.). Secondly, from the socio-economic and spatial perspective, the PMRs aim to bring an additional dynamic to the UPZ, designating commercial use around the new interventions in order to generate more employment at the local scale. Here the perfect situation and scenario inside the city's legal framework can be found to start a new dynamic in a deprived neighbourhood.
In another initiative, the Institute of Urban Development (IDU) has already started to design the first two of a total of eight Metro Cable lines. Bogotá is a city with a very uneven topography and many of the informal and poorest settlements are located on the hilly slopes of the city. Ciudad Bolívar, one of the most drastically steep parts of the city, has been selected as the priority, as it is also one of the most deprived localities in Bogotá. The first line will connect the *Portal Tunal* with the informal neighbourhood of *El Paraíso* (image). One of the two intermediate stations is going to be located next to the Limas creek PMR (SDM, 2013). This mobility intervention will carry 2.400 passengers per hour and will optimize the travel times from one hour by bus to 13,4 minutes (El Espectador, 2013).

Medellín's Metro Cable is one of the most successful examples of how these mobility projects are an effective way to bridge the gap of poverty. Firstly, these types of interventions generate a sense of belonging towards the city and its institutions. The inhabitants recognize that the city is investing money in impressive infrastructure projects in their neighbourhoods. Secondly, the confidence in the institutions increases and upgrading projects from the dwellers and other types of private investments

[5] Currently is has 9 lines and 8 Portales (terminus stations) in the TransMilenio System. Portal Usme is one of them.

GRAPH 8. TRANSPORTATION SYSTEM OF BOGOTÁ

GRAPH 9.



in the neighbourhood will likely follow (Dávila and Brand, 2013). Finally, Medellín has paid special attention to deliver the best architectural projects in these poor neighbourhoods in order to raise pride and esteem in the community, generating an enormous sense of belonging of their districts (Alcaldía de Medellín, 2008). As Hylton claims, behind these well done interventions, there is a more profound meaning: the reconstruction of the social fabric disrupted for decades by the country's inner violence problems (2007). This could be described as a successful urban acupuncture intervention, since the local government is appointing the most marginal areas of the city and the way of addressing the community's needs is through high quality urban projects connected to the rest of the city via the MetroCable. The main goal is to provide urban facilities and upgrade the public space that surrounds them in order to connect the urban intervention with other urban facilities or a commercial hub or centrality in the area.

Following the three previous ideas (sense of belonging, confidence in institutions and best quality of architectural projects) and merging the whole information provided above, Bogotá has the perfect scenario in terms of regulation and infrastructure projects. It is time for the city's institutions to combine all the efforts applied in this marginal zone, and to take advantage of this unique opportunity to change the quality of life of many poor people in the city. Moreover, these types of interventions fit perfectly in the essence of the city's regulatory framework and the latest urban tendencies for slum upgrading projects. If Bogotá follows the good example of Medellín, the city will improve the lives of the UPZ67 El Lucero inhabitants in physical, economical, environmental, cultural-educational and accessibility terms. The physical shape of the neighbourhood will acquire a very attractive

GRAPH 9. UPZ67 EL LUCERO AND THE PMR LOCATED IN THE AREA. SOURCE IDU AND TRANSMILENIO, 2013 SOURCE CARTILLA UPZ67 EL LUCERO, 2006, SDM, 2013

manner, inviting new dynamics to appear.

The problem is that, even though the city has all the elements to have a successful slum-upgrading policy, the institutions in charge of the projects do not have the holistic approach or an 'umbrella institution' that coordinates all the investments and projects involved in one area. The CODI example could be a good solution in terms on and institutional approach to the problem. Not only as an umbrella organization in charge of the process and supervising that all the efforts are being invested in the most effective way, but also incorporating participatory processes to enhance the sense of belonging and the appropriation of these projects by the community. This is one of the most effective ways to create an inclusive policy, empowering the dwellers and providing citizenship to places where the inhabitants do not feel part of the city. In most of the cases, it is the first time that the city's interventions are for everyone. As Ortiz claims the city has a debt with their citizens and the community that is finally being paid with this infrastructure and urban projects of the absence of the state in the territory for many decades (2013). This approach is crucial to have successful and effective policies, embracing all the aspects the community need to be able to upgrade their current situation and improve their quality of life through urban interventions.

Bringing Medellín again as an example, many inhabitants of other parts of the city visit the innovative urban projects (e.g. libraries, schools and parks) linked with the Metro Cable intervention. The best Colombian and even international architects are the designers of these new urban projects. Additionally, it could generate employment and connect the dwellers with the other services of the city through the Metro Cable. These urban projects are acting as acupuncture points, providing many types of services to a marginal community to trigger the change of the area gradually, but with an enormous impact. It is very important to highlight again that the interventions are not meant to be isolated in terms of accessibility, public space and connectivity with the city. As Brand states, the MetroCable cannot work by itself (2013). The social intervention is a system composed by public transportation (the MetroCable itself providing accessibility to the area), public space (the upgrading of sidewalks, parks, stairs and ramps to connect the acupuncture urban interventions with each other) and the urban projects (providing the services that were lacking in the area) (*ibid.*). This is the perfect scenario to upgrade capabilities at a real level. Providing spaces for high educational institutions, health clinics or commercial hubs in order to create more job opportunities are the best way to give the community the scenario to enhance their capabilities.

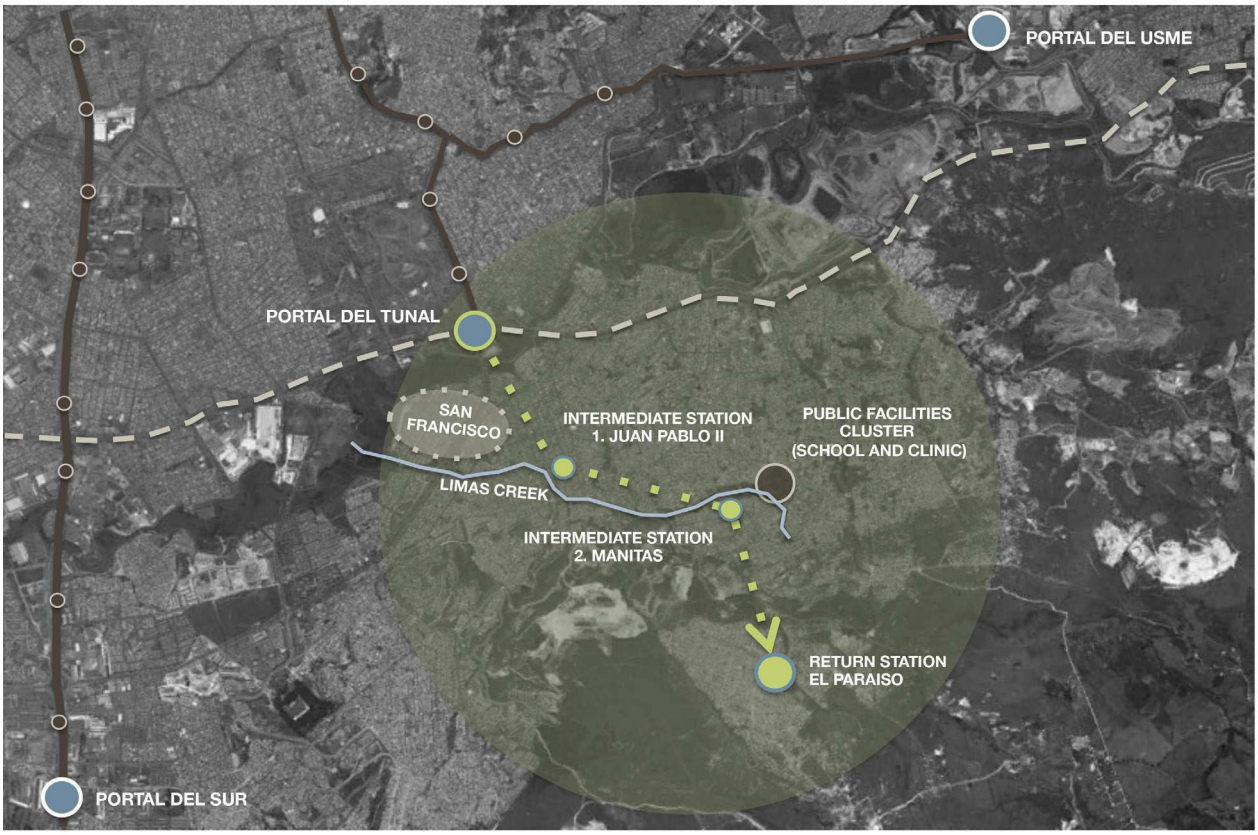
In environmental terms, people will be using very clean energies system instead of the old buses with high pollution that currently take people to El Lucero. The city should also take advantage of these types of interventions to upgrade the public space of the area, guaranteeing the connectivity or these urban projects with the public transportation system, in this case, the MetroCable. In this particular case, the intervention is tacking place on the *"Limas"* creek, which is one of the pedestrian corridors that connect El Lucero with the commercial cluster in San Francisco (see Graph 10). The public space connectivity with this commercial centrality should be also implemented in this intervention. It is important to highlight that the main public facilities cluster of the area (a school and a GP level Clinic) are only a few block away from the station. This connectivity is also crucial in order to ensure the mix of activities and the change of dynamic in the neighbourhood an acupuncture intervention is supposed to provide. Many of the projects that should be proposed in these areas due to its deficit are libraries, hospitals, nursery schools and universities. Other crucial urban facilities for these interventions are the technical schools and entrepreneurial centres. Their main purpose is to help the community with the improvement of their technical skills and the chance to have start-up projects, ideally with the accompaniment of private sector companies, willing to provide real opportunities to urban poor. In this sense, the upgrading of the capabilities seams to be more real and tangible for urban dwellers. These services are scarce in informal settlements and provide many advantageous services of all kind to urban dwellers. Finally, in terms of accessibility, the intervention is saving precious travel time to its inhabitants, but also opening a dangerous area to the city, providing more security to its inhabitants. The labyrinth of





PICTURE 3. OVERVIEW FROM EL LUCERO FROM THE TRANSMILENIO

PICTURE 4. PERSPECTIVE OF EL LUCERO STATION SOURCE SILVA, 2011



GRAPH 10.

houses is nowadays more accessible not only for its inhabitants but for the security bodies of the city due to this transit interventions. In these sense, the multisectorial approach of the intervention is being fulfilled.

In the last decades, Bogotá has experienced a process of rapid urbanisation like many cities in the global south, due to the rural-urban migration.

GRAPH 10. CONNECTIVITY OF EL LUCERO WITH OTHE URBAN FACILITIES AND THE CITY'S PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION. SOURCE SDM, 2013 TRANSMILENIO S.A, 2013

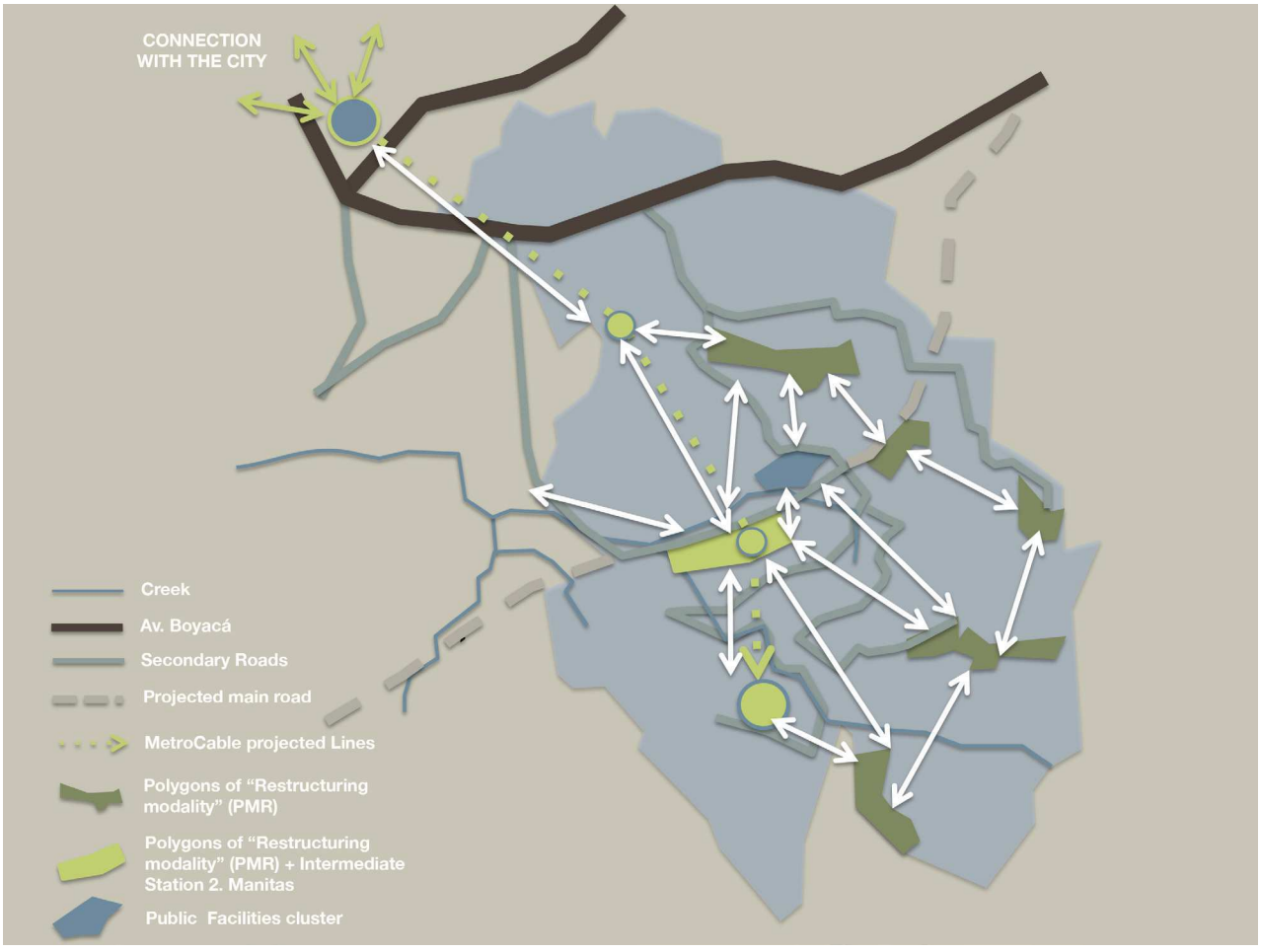
5 Conclusion

Most of these new parts of the city respond to the lack of efficient governmental policies. As a result, informal settlements emerged in the peripheries of the city in an unorganized way and with many deficiencies in terms of public space, urban facilities and economic opportunities for its dwellers. Bogotá has been implementing many attempts to address, though urban policies, urban growth and informal settlements. The city has had some more effective periods than other in terms of housing and slum up-grading policies.

The late decade, the city has been very passive in terms of policies, due to the political will and capability of the last three mayor's period. Nonetheless, Bogotá has a very sophisticated normative framework (POT) that the mayor Peñalosa and mayor Mokus left to the city in the early 2000s. This *POT* includes several programmes and urban instruments to tackle urban poverty like the MIB and the legalization processes for slums. The city should take advantage of that already existing legal and normative framework to be able to formulate more effective policies to tackle urban poverty in a multidimensional way, ensuring that these policies will upgrade the people's capabilities in order to provide real and tangible opportunities. These intentions could be materialized in urban acupuncture projects through integral urban projects that also enhance the sense of belonging and citizenship in these marginal areas.

In order to have a successful and effective slum-upgrading policy, Bogotá should create one institution with the capacity to coordinate all the stakeholder involved in such a complex process. This paper used CODI as a good example to be followed, since the Thai institution has led successful slum-upgrading projects,

GRAPH 11.



GRAPH 11. UPZ67. EL LUCERO AND THE CONNECTION OF THE PMRS LOCATED IN THE AREA. SOURCE CARTILLA UPZ67 EL LUCERO, 2006, SDM, 2013 AND ANALYSIS OF THE AUTHOR

hand in hand with the community, ensuring participatory process and a more just approach of the policies and programmes. It also ensures the holistic approach of every intervention in order to have a multidimensional impact in the targeted community. It is a matter to join forces towards the same goal, and use the limited public resources in the most effective way to have the biggest impact in the community. Furthermore, in order to have an effective slum-upgrading policy in the UPZ67 El Lucero, it is really important to have connectivity, through public space, of the 7 PMT the MIB programme designed for the UPZ (see Graph 11). Every PMR could have a different type of urban project (e.g. school, technical university, health clinic, nursery, commercial cluster plaza, entrepreneurial centre, sport facility) to provide the lacking services the UPZ nowadays has. Furthermore, these interventions provide the presence of the state in marginal and dangerous areas. In a way governability could be witness for the first time, providing security and trust.

At the same time, these urban interventions will act as catalyst for change, providing new opportunities in terms of education, employment and health. This is the main goal of an urban acupuncture project. To positively impact a territory with strategic interventions that upgrade, not only the physical but also the quality of life of the urban dwellers of the whole UPZ. This also helps the project to gain scale and impact in the targeted community. The combination of the urban services that the whole UPZ is going to acquire with the intervention, will help to upgrade the capabilities of urban dweller, providing the area with better education and job opportunities, a safer and healthier habitat and the accessibility of the zone and the connection of a marginal zone with the other urban services of the city.

Finally, in this context it is acknowledged that the informal settlement has problems but it is understood as a crucial part of the solution. It has potentials and opportunities to really make thinks change in a sustainable manner. In order to achieve an inclusive policy, the city needs to adopt participatory processes with the community to really identify their urgent needs in order to deliver them back in the shape of urban projects and physical interventions. The municipality has the obligation to ensure that the community's requirements will be 'translate' into technical terms and developed then into policies. These interventions are bringing also a sense of belonging and pride to the dwellers of the area. Consequently, this could be translated into a generation of confidence into the city's institutions, since these marginal areas have few evident interventions and the absence of the state is the common feeling among their inhabitants. Moreover it delivers citizenship in areas of the city that do not participate in the political dynamics and do not exercise their obligations as citizens because they do not trust in the institutions. In that sense, the community should not only act as a claimer of its rights, but also should contribute into the democratic channels the city provides them. Furthermore, it is important that citizens participate also in the monitory and evaluation process of these urban interventions in order to assure the desired positive impact to the community.

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